MICHAEL CARRUTH

ENGINEERING & PRODUCT LEADER | AI PLATFORMS & DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS

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PROFILE

Hands-on engineering and product leader with 20+ years at Amazon and Microsoft who fixes what's broken, builds what's missing, and stabilizes what's failing. Combines deep platform architecture expertise with a track record of building and leading organizations of up to 100+ people. Takes emerging technologies into production, from zero-to-one agentic AI systems to global-scale cloud and advertising platforms.

LEADERSHIP & TECHNICAL FOCUS

Agentic AI Platforms • Architecture & Distributed Systems • Zero-to-One Product Delivery • Engineering Organization Leadership • Developer Platforms & Extensibility • Cross-Organizational Technical Strategy

EXPERIENCE

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Amazon Ads | 2026–Present

Agentic AI Platform

- Founded and lead a 25-person engineering and technical program organization, with leaders including a Senior Software Development Manager and three Principal Technical Program Managers.
- Led a zero-to-one agentic AI product from conception through public launch in 25 markets worldwide; accountable for technical strategy, platform architecture, and engineering delivery.
- Defined the agent platform's orchestration and extensibility architecture, including standardized tool integration, skills, durable knowledge, and evaluation infrastructure.
- Drive technical alignment and program execution across organizational boundaries within a 10,000-person engineering organization, reconciling competing approaches and complex dependencies.

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Devices Software & Services | 2020–2022

Setup, Connectivity & IoT Platforms

- Led device setup and messaging platform expansion supporting more than 100 million concurrent connections; reduced latency by over 50% in India.
- Challenged a flawed revenue model three months before hardware launch, preserving an $8 million investment and enabling on-time delivery; the replacement model, built on real customer acquisition data, changed how Devices evaluates product viability.
- Recovered a failed device beta within two weeks by refocusing on customer trust and changing firmware behavior; improved customer ratings from 2.0 to 4.5 stars.
- Built operating review, talent calibration, and succession planning mechanisms that stabilized execution and improved promotion and retention outcomes.

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Advertising | 2019–2020

Sponsored Brands & Video

- Grew an engineering organization from 50 to more than 75 people across two sites, supporting multi-billion-dollar advertising platforms.
- Launched Advertiser Strategies, enabling more than 25% year-over-year growth in advertiser spend through improved campaign optimization and targeting.

AMAZON | Senior Software Development Manager, Devices Software & Services | 2014–2019

Offline Retail Platform

- Led a platform enabling device sales in 15 countries through 500 retailers; architected technology supporting Amazon's first 100+ physical retail kiosks and in-store programs at Kohl's, Whole Foods, malls, and airports.
- Automated sales and operations planning, reducing planning cost 75%, shortening cycles from monthly to daily, and halving out-of-stock rates.
- Recovered a failing nationwide rollout by rebuilding telemetry and deployment orchestration; stabilized more than 98% of deployments within two weeks.
- Established and grew a Denver engineering site from zero to 25 engineers.

MICROSOFT | Principal Software Development Manager, Bing Ads | 2008–2014

Advertising Platforms

- Designed and launched a self-service Google Ads import workflow that materially accelerated advertiser growth and revenue.
- Scaled Microsoft Advertising Editor from limited beta to general availability; grew usage 200-fold and received a Microsoft Gold Star Award.

MICROSOFT | Principal Software Development Manager, Windows | 2004–2008

Core Operating System Division

- Led the team responsible for Microsoft Application Compatibility Toolkit, helping enterprise customers identify and remediate software compatibility issues.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Agent orchestration, tool integration / MCP, skills and knowledge architecture, evaluation systems; AWS and cloud platforms; high-scale messaging, device connectivity, advertising platforms

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

B.S., Computer Science — Auburn University

Amazon Bar Raiser | Microsoft Gold Star Award | ADP Innovation Excellence Award